

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 6: The Age of Reorganisation

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	6 — The Age of Reorganisation
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct.

Apex traps: distinguish CAUSE from mere SEQUENCE (internal Mauryan breakup preceded and enabled the foreign entry into the northwest, so a later event cannot be the earlier collapse's cause); never swap Gandhara (Greco-Buddhist, wavy hair and toga-folds, the visible confluence) with Mathura (indigenous red sandstone, fuller forms); SEA routes carried Satavahana and Tamil trade to Rome while the Kushanas profited from the overland LAND Silk Route; foreign rulers were absorbed into a dominant Indian culture (contributors, not destroyers); an ashvamedha or a matrimonial alliance is a political-sovereignty act, not merely ritual or a wedding; royal women (mother-names, land-granting queens, a queen's horse-sacrifice) wielded real power; weigh sources by their strengths (inscription = fixed-wording deed/gift, coin = name/title/portrait, poem = value that may flatter); a stupa is a Buddhist dome, an anicut a river-dam, a samvat a counted era; and keep the dynastic order straight (Maurya breakup, then Satavahanas, then Kanishka). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A teacher draws a timeline: (1) the Maurya empire weakens internally, (2) its last ruler is killed by his commander, (3) Indo-Greeks move into the northwest. A pupil concludes, 'Therefore the Indo-Greeks caused the Maurya empire to fall.' The single sharpest flaw in this conclusion is that it:

(A) wrongly assumes the commander who killed the last ruler was himself an Indo-Greek

(B) treats an event placed later on the timeline as the cause of an event that had already happened before it

- (C) ignores that the Indo-Greeks and the Mauryas were really the same dynasty
- (D) forgets that the northwest had never been part of the Maurya empire

2. Two students debate the label for these centuries. One says 'Age of Reorganisation', the other 'Age of Decline'. Which observation would do the MOST to settle the dispute in favour of 'reorganisation' rather than 'decline'?

- (A) the period was finally reunified by a single emperor who ended all rivalry
- (B) every kingdom of the period was governed by a foreign ruler
- (C) the period left no coins, inscriptions or monuments behind for historians
- (D) across the period new schools of sculpture, long-distance trade and lasting Sanskrit works all flourished even as kingdoms rose and fell

3. A historian writes that calling these centuries a 'dark age' is misleading. The strongest single reason this label fails, drawn from the chapter, is that a true dark age would imply a collapse of creative and economic life, whereas in fact:

- (A) a powerful single empire kept the whole subcontinent peaceful throughout
- (B) art schools, busy sea and land trade and enduring literature all advanced during the very same centuries
- (C) writing disappeared so completely that no records of the age survive
- (D) all the kingdoms of the age were ruled directly from Rome

4. Pushyamitra's seizure of power and the Indo-Greeks' arrival are sometimes lumped together as 'the forces that ended the Mauryas'. The chapter would correct this by pointing out that the two were fundamentally different in that:

- (A) Pushyamitra was an insider who took the throne from within the Mauryan state, while the Indo-Greeks were outsiders who only later moved into an already weakened frontier
- (B) both were foreign peoples invading the heartland at the same moment
- (C) Pushyamitra arrived from Central Asia while the Indo-Greeks rose inside the Ganga plain
- (D) both came to power by being elected by the Mauryan nobles

5. A king of this age frees a horse to roam for a year with his army following, then performs a great sacrifice. A separate king ends a long rivalry by giving his daughter in marriage to a neighbour. What do BOTH acts have most fundamentally in common?

- (A) each is purely a religious devotion with no bearing on politics
- (B) each is a political instrument that advances a ruler's power or relations, not merely a private or religious act
- (C) each is mainly a way of collecting yearly tribute from a rival
- (D) each is a method of choosing the next ruler of the kingdom

6. An inscription records that a WIDOWED Satavahana queen herself performed the ashvamedha. From this single record a careful historian can soundly infer ALL of the

following EXCEPT:

- (A) that women in this age more commonly ruled than men did
- (B) that royal women could exercise real political and ritual authority
- (C) that the Satavahanas still kept up Vedic sacrifice in her time
- (D) that performing the rite was understood as a claim to sovereignty

7. A Satavahana king is named 'Gautamiputra' after his mother Gautami, and inscriptions separately record that same Gautami Balashri donating land. A student lists four possible conclusions. Which conclusion is BOTH supported by the evidence AND the strongest one the two facts TOGETHER justify?

- (A) royal women stood high enough that a king could be named after his mother and that a queen could publicly endow gifts
- (B) kings were always named after the chief god they personally worshipped
- (C) the king had renounced the throne to live as a Buddhist monk
- (D) 'Gautami' was the name of the dynasty's first capital city

8. Which combination of THREE facts, taken together, most decisively overturns the claim 'in these kingdoms only men ever held power'?

- (A) kings named after their mothers, queens recorded donating land in inscriptions, and a queen performing the ashvamedha
- (B) ship-coins, hoards of Roman gold and a Silk-Route milestone
- (C) the Bharhut Stupa, the Heliodorus pillar and the Grand Anicut
- (D) Sangam poems, the Shaka calendar and Kanishka's many-gods coins

9. It seems contradictory that the Vedic-reviving Shungas adorned the Buddhist Bharhut Stupa. The chapter resolves the apparent contradiction by establishing a general principle about the age, namely that:

- (A) the Shungas had secretly converted to Buddhism while only pretending to revive Vedic rites
- (B) the Bharhut Stupa was really a Vedic temple that has been mislabelled
- (C) Buddhism had already died out, so the stupa was only an empty shell
- (D) a ruler who favoured one religious tradition could still sponsor fine art belonging to a different one

10. A reference card pairs four glossary terms with definitions. Which single pairing is the ONLY one that is correct?

- (A) stupa — a low dam that diverts a river into canals
- (B) samvat — a counted era reckoned from a fixed starting event
- (C) anicut — a dome-shaped Buddhist monument with carved railings
- (D) ashvamedha — an anthology of early Tamil love-and-heroism poems

11. On a labelled map of this age you must shade four regions: the Shungas, the Satavahanas, Kharavela's kingdom, and the Pandyas. Which set of placements is entirely

correct?

- (A) Shungas in the Deccan, Satavahanas in Kalinga, Kharavela in the Tamil south, Pandyas in the northwest
- (B) Shungas in north-central India, Satavahanas in the Deccan, Kharavela in Kalinga on the east coast, Pandyas in the Tamil far south
- (C) Shungas in the Tamil south, Satavahanas in the northwest, Kharavela in the Deccan, Pandyas in north-central India
- (D) Shungas in Kalinga, Satavahanas in the Tamil south, Kharavela in north-central India, Pandyas in the Deccan

12. A museum lays out three objects in a gallery called 'India and the Wider World': a Satavahana ship-coin, a hoard of Roman gold from a Tamil port, and a Kushana Silk-Route milestone. A label must state what UNITES all three. The best label is:

- (A) Rome and China between them militarily conquered India in this age
- (B) this age tied India into long-distance commerce by both sea and overland routes
- (C) India in this age traded only within its own villages and ports
- (D) all of India's foreign contact in this age passed along a single route

13. Roman gold coins keep turning up at Indian ports, yet historians refuse to conclude that Rome ruled India. The best methodological reason is that:

- (A) the coins were all forgeries struck in India and never came from Rome at all
- (B) Rome was too distant for any of its goods ever to reach India
- (C) Indian kings personally travelled to Rome to be crowned each year
- (D) coin finds prove commercial exchange, while political rule would require evidence such as Roman governors, garrisons or administrative records

14. A historian must judge which is the stronger source for the standing of royal women: (i) a queen's land-grant carved in an inscription, or (ii) a court poem praising a queen's generosity. The sounder choice and reason is:

- (A) the poem, because poems of this age were always more accurate than inscriptions
- (B) the inscription, because queens always carved their own inscriptions by hand
- (C) neither, because no source from this age can tell us anything about women
- (D) the inscription, because it records an actual act in fixed wording, whereas a praise-poem may exaggerate to flatter

15. A teacher says, 'A coin and an inscription are both physical sources, but they answer different questions best.' Which pairing of strengths is correct?

- (A) a coin best records long narrative deeds, while an inscription best shows a portrait
- (B) both are unreliable because neither can ever give a ruler's name
- (C) a coin best preserves a ruler's name, titles and portrait, while an inscription best records a specific deed or gift in words
- (D) a coin is a modern forgery while an inscription is the only genuine source

16. Kanishka's coins carry his royal titles alongside images of many different gods, while Indo-Greek coins are prized chiefly for supplying rulers' names and portraits where inscriptions are scarce. The best general lesson about COINS as evidence is that they:

- (A) are useful only for measuring the metal wealth of a kingdom
- (B) tell us nothing beyond which gods a people refused to worship
- (C) are valuable only because they were never actually used in trade
- (D) can reveal a ruler's identity, titles and even religious leanings when other written records are thin

17. The Satavahanas and the Kushanas both grew rich on trade, yet a careful reader must NOT confuse their routes. The correct statement is that the:

- (A) Satavahanas prospered through western SEA ports while the Kushanas profited from the overland LAND Silk Route
- (B) both prospered chiefly through the overland Silk Route
- (C) Satavahanas profited from the Silk Route while the Kushanas traded by sea
- (D) both prospered chiefly through western sea ports

18. Both the Satavahanas and the Tamil kingdoms reached the Roman world, but they did so by the SAME kind of route. A student then wrongly adds the Kushanas to this same group. The accurate correction is that:

- (A) all three reached Rome by the overland Silk Route, so the student is right to group them
- (B) the Satavahanas reached Rome by land and the Tamils by sea, so neither belongs with the Kushanas
- (C) the Tamil kingdoms reached Rome by the Silk Route while the Satavahanas used the sea
- (D) the Satavahanas and Tamil kingdoms reached Rome by sea, whereas the Kushanas' wealth came from the overland Silk Route, so the Kushanas do not belong with them

19. Roman writers describe pepper and other goods of the Tamil coast in detail. A pupil claims this 'proves Rome ruled south India'. The flaw is best stated as:

- (A) Roman writers only ever described lands their own armies had conquered
- (B) the description actually proves Tamil kings ruled provinces inside Italy
- (C) knowing a region's goods can come simply from buying them, so detailed knowledge shows trade rather than political control
- (D) Roman writers could not have learned about pepper without colonising the coast

20. Sangam poems mostly celebrate love, heroism and open-handed giving by chiefs. Which conclusion about the Sangam-age south is the MOST that a historian can reliably draw from this, and no more?

- (A) rulers were legally forbidden from ever giving away gifts
- (B) wealth was shared so equally that chiefs did not exist at all

- (C) the poems prove the south followed only Vedic sacrificial rules
- (D) generosity was prized as a mark of a worthy ruler in that society

21. A glossary entry reads: 'anicut = a coastal fort built to keep out enemy ships.' Using the chapter, the correction needed is that an anicut is actually:

- (A) a dome-shaped Buddhist monument ringed with carved railings
- (B) a counted calendar era reckoned from a fixed starting event
- (C) a low dam that raises a river's water so it can be diverted into irrigation canals
- (D) a treaty of marriage binding two royal houses together

22. Why did the Grand Anicut matter more to Chola prosperity than a coastal fort of the same cost would have?

- (A) it served as the dynasty's strongest military fortress against rivals
- (B) it blocked enemy ships from sailing up the Kaveri to the capital
- (C) by spreading the Kaveri's water across the delta it created rich rice land, the agricultural base of the kingdom's wealth
- (D) it marked the fixed boundary line with the neighbouring Pandyas

23. A pupil arranges four developments earliest-first: Maurya breakup, rise of the Satavahanas, Kanishka's Kushana rule, and the entry of the Indo-Greeks into the northwest. Which ordering is correct?

- (A) Kanishka's Kushana rule, then the Maurya breakup, then the Indo-Greeks, then the Satavahanas
- (B) the rise of the Satavahanas, then the Maurya breakup, then Kanishka, then the Indo-Greeks
- (C) the Indo-Greeks entering the northwest, then the Maurya breakup, then Kanishka, then the Satavahanas
- (D) Maurya breakup, then the Indo-Greeks entering the weakened northwest, then the rise of the Satavahanas, then Kanishka's Kushana rule

24. Which pairing correctly contrasts an INDIGENOUS power of this age with a FOREIGN one, AND correctly identifies which is which?

- (A) the Indo-Greeks (indigenous) versus the Kushanas (foreign)
- (B) the Satavahanas (foreign) versus the Shungas (indigenous)
- (C) the Shungas of the heartland (indigenous) versus the Indo-Greeks of the northwest (foreign)
- (D) the Cholas (foreign) versus the Pandyas (indigenous)

25. Suppose a Shunga-era Bharhut railing and an Indo-Greek silver coin both survive from about the same century. Which single statement contrasts them ACCURATELY?

- (A) both are works of the indigenous Mathura red-sandstone school of sculpture
- (B) the railing is Buddhist religious art made in the Indian heartland, while the coin is the chief portrait record of a foreign ruler of the northwest

- (C) both were produced by foreign rulers descended from Alexander's governors
- (D) both are tokens of sea trade used to pay for Roman pepper

26. A coin shows a Hellenistic-style royal portrait on one face and an Indian deity named in Indian script on the other. Which broad conclusion does this single object most strongly support?

- (A) the foreign issuer merged Greek conventions with Indian ones rather than keeping the two cultures apart
- (B) the issuer rejected Indian languages and gods altogether
- (C) the issuer ruled the whole subcontinent under one uniform coinage
- (D) the issuer took no interest in trade or money of any kind

27. The Heliodorus pillar was set up by a GREEK ambassador to honour an INDIAN god. As a single object it is most powerful for proving which point?

- (A) the Indo-Greeks forced Greek gods on every Indian subject they ruled
- (B) the Indo-Greeks refused all contact with Indian religion
- (C) the Indo-Greeks could blend Greek and Indian culture, even adopting Indian beliefs
- (D) the Indo-Greeks demolished Indian shrines wherever they held power

28. Two sculptures stand side by side. One shows the Buddha in toga-like folds with wavy hair; the other is a fuller, rounder figure carved in spotted red sandstone. A label-writer must assign schools AND say which one better illustrates 'cultural confluence'. The correct answer is:

- (A) the first is Mathura and better shows confluence; the second is Gandhara, a foreign style
- (B) both are Gandhara, and the red-sandstone one better shows confluence
- (C) the first is Gandhara and better shows confluence; the second is Mathura, an indigenous style
- (D) the first is Mathura and the second is Gandhara, and neither shows any confluence

29. Why is Gandhara art a BETTER single illustration of 'cultural confluence' than the Mathura style is?

- (A) Gandhara was made entirely without any foreign influence whatsoever
- (B) Mathura was a foreign Greek school while Gandhara was purely Indian
- (C) Gandhara was a school of Tamil poetry rather than of sculpture
- (D) Gandhara visibly fuses a foreign Greek form with an Indian Buddhist subject, while Mathura is essentially one indigenous tradition

30. A textbook prints: 'Gandhara — indigenous red sandstone; Mathura — Greek robes and wavy hair.' The single correction that fixes BOTH halves at once is:

- (A) Gandhara fused Greek forms with Buddhist subjects, while Mathura was an indigenous red-sandstone style
- (B) Gandhara was Tamil poetry while Mathura was Greek sculpture

- (C) both schools were purely Greek with no Indian element at all
- (D) both were styles of Tamil poetry rather than sculpture

31. Assertion: the foreign rulers of this age are usually counted among contributors to Indian civilisation rather than its destroyers. Reason: Indian culture stayed dominant and reshaped much of what the newcomers brought. Which judgement is correct?

- (A) the assertion is true but the reason is false
- (B) the assertion is false though the reason is true
- (C) both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion
- (D) both the assertion and the reason are false

32. That foreign rulers' coins and art repeatedly ended up with 'Indian themes always at the heart' is best read as evidence that India:

- (A) violently expelled every trace of foreign influence from its art
- (B) was wholly Hellenised and lost its own cultural identity
- (C) halted all artistic activity for the duration of the foreign presence
- (D) absorbed and reshaped the newcomers rather than being erased by them

33. Which single statement is the ODD ONE OUT because it MISDESCRIBES its subject?

- (A) the Shungas revived Vedic ritual and adorned the Bharhut Stupa
- (B) the Kushanas grew rich mainly by sea trade through the western Deccan ports
- (C) the Satavahanas carried on sea trade evidenced by ship-coins
- (D) the Cholas built the Grand Anicut to irrigate the Kaveri delta

34. A pupil claims that 'because the age had many rival kingdoms, it must have been culturally barren'. The single best counter-example from the chapter, combining political division WITH cultural richness, is that:

- (A) a single emperor unified the subcontinent and then sponsored the arts
- (B) during the same centuries of rival kingdoms, new art schools, busy trade and great Sanskrit works all flourished
- (C) all art and trade stopped until one large empire was restored
- (D) the foreign rulers banned every form of Indian culture in their lands

35. Kharavela is called a 'monk-king'. Using the chapter, the label is best explained by saying he:

- (A) ruled Kalinga as its king while himself being a devout follower of Jainism
- (B) gave up his throne to wander the land as a homeless monk
- (C) served as a Kushana governor of Gandhara in the far northwest
- (D) founded an entirely new monastic religion of his own creation

36. Almost everything known about Kharavela comes from a single rock-cut record, the Hathigumpha inscription. This dependence best illustrates a general truth about the age,

namely that historians often must:

- (A) rely on year-by-year chronicles kept continuously at every royal court
- (B) depend on Roman trade ledgers that listed each Indian king by name
- (C) reconstruct a ruler's deeds from writing carved into lasting material rather than from continuous written chronicles
- (D) use Tamil Sangam poems composed in honour of eastern kings

37. Which list names **ONLY** the three crowned Tamil kingdoms of the southern country, with no intruder?

- (A) Cholas, Cheras and Satavahanas (B) Shungas, Cheras and Pandyas
- (C) Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas (D) Cholas, Pandyas and Kushanas

38. The Shakas who settled in India are also called the Indo-Scythians, and the lasting calendar linked to their era is the Shaka samvat. A pupil who says 'the Shakas are the same as the Indo-Greeks and left no lasting calendar' has made which **TWO** errors?

- (A) the Shakas are indeed the Indo-Greeks, but they did leave the Shaka samvat
- (B) the Shakas are the Indo-Scythians, and correctly they left no lasting calendar
- (C) the Shakas are the Indo-Scythians, not the Indo-Greeks, and they **ARE** linked to a lasting calendar, the Shaka samvat
- (D) the Shakas are the Kushanas, and they left the Roman Julian calendar

39. That India's official national calendar still counts years from the Shaka era is best used to argue that this age:

- (A) left lasting marks on Indian life rather than leaving only ruins
- (B) produced nothing that outlived its own time
- (C) was entirely the creation of Roman officials
- (D) had no genuine contact with Indian traditions

40. Among the rulers of this age, which name is correctly matched with the right power **AND** the right achievement?

- (A) Pushyamitra — a Kushana ruler who controlled the Silk Route
- (B) Kanishka — a Kushana ruler associated with control of the Silk Route
- (C) Kharavela — a Satavahana ruler who built the Grand Anicut
- (D) Gautamiputra — an Indo-Greek ruler who set up the Heliodorus pillar

41. The Kushanas' exceptional wealth rested chiefly on a route that a coastal-trading Satavahana could not have controlled. That route is:

- (A) the overland Silk Route linking China to the Mediterranean through Central Asia
- (B) the western Deccan sea routes to the Roman world
- (C) the Kaveri delta canals fed by the Grand Anicut
- (D) the touring circuit followed by Tamil Sangam poets

42. The 'Silk Route' is most precisely described as:

- (A) a single sea lane running directly from the Deccan to Rome
- (B) a road the Cholas built across the Kaveri delta
- (C) a network of overland trade routes joining China to the Mediterranean through Central Asia
- (D) a touring circuit followed by Tamil Sangam poets

43. Which great works of Sanskrit literature does the chapter associate with this age, and why does naming them matter for the period's reputation?

- (A) the Sangam Tamil anthologies, because they prove the north produced no literature
- (B) the Mahabharata and the Ramayana, because their flourishing shows the age was creatively rich, not a cultural void
- (C) the Hathigumpha inscription, because it is the age's only literary work
- (D) the Arthashastra of the Mauryan court, because it was newly composed in this age

44. A pupil writes: 'Coins and inscriptions matter so much for this age because the people then could not read or write.' The chapter would correct the REASON while keeping the conclusion, explaining instead that:

- (A) no one alive then could read or write at all, so nothing was recorded
- (B) much of our evidence for the age's rulers, trade and religion is physical rather than surviving as written chronicles
- (C) the period left behind no buildings whatsoever for historians to study
- (D) every written history of the age was a translation made in Rome

45. Which list contains ONLY items that can serve as PHYSICAL (material) sources for this age?

- (A) coins, cave inscriptions and sculptures
- (B) coins, election ballots and newspapers
- (C) emails, photographs and passports
- (D) constitutions, voter rolls and tax records

46. A coin from the northwest shows a Greek-style king on one side and an Indian god on the other; an inscription in the Deccan records a queen's land-grant. A student says 'these two sources show the same thing'. The most accurate response is that:

- (A) they show the same thing, namely that Rome ruled both regions
- (B) they show the same thing, namely that both regions used the Silk Route
- (C) neither tells us anything, because coins and inscriptions are unreliable
- (D) they show different things — the coin shows cultural blending under a foreign ruler, while the inscription shows a royal woman's standing

47. A historian wants the single best argument that the foreign rulers were 'contributors to', not 'destroyers of', Indian civilisation. Which package of evidence makes that case most directly?

- (A) Roman gold hoards, Satavahana ship-coins and the Grand Anicut
- (B) the Bharhut Stupa, Sangam poetry and the three crowned Tamil kingdoms

- (C) the Hathigumpha inscription, Kharavela's Jainism and the Kaveri delta
- (D) Gandhara art blending Greek form with Buddhist subjects, Kanishka's coins honouring many gods, and the Heliodorus pillar's reverence for an Indian deity

48. Which inference about the SHUNGAS is the ONE the chapter actually supports, as opposed to a common misreading?

- (A) they revived Vedic ritual yet still patronised the Buddhist Bharhut Stupa
- (B) they were a foreign dynasty descended from Alexander's governors
- (C) they grew rich by controlling the overland Silk Route
- (D) they built the Grand Anicut to irrigate the Kaveri delta

49. A Satavahana coin stamped with a two-masted ship and found near a Deccan port is offered as proof of something. Which conclusion does it support, and which does it NOT?

- (A) it supports thriving sea trade through western ports, but does not prove the dynasty had lost all its land territory
- (B) it supports that the dynasty worshipped the sea as a god, but not that it traded
- (C) it supports that the dynasty built a war-fleet against the Kushanas, but not that it traded
- (D) it supports that the dynasty had lost its land and survived only at sea

50. Why does the chapter treat a matrimonial alliance as more than 'just a wedding'?

- (A) because linking two royal families by marriage could turn rivals into allies and secure or extend a kingdom's reach, making it an act of diplomacy
- (B) because every royal wedding of the age included a horse-sacrifice
- (C) because marriages were the only way a king could collect tribute
- (D) because such marriages were purely private family events with no wider meaning

51. A pupil argues: 'Since the Satavahanas, Cheras and Pandyas all traded with Rome by sea, the Kushanas must have done the same.' The reasoning fails because it:

- (A) wrongly denies that the Satavahanas traded by sea at all
- (B) wrongly claims the Cheras and Pandyas were not Tamil kingdoms
- (C) assumes a pattern true of the southern and Deccan powers must hold for the Kushanas, whose wealth in fact came from the overland Silk Route
- (D) wrongly states that Rome lay along the overland Silk Route

52. Which statement about the foreign rulers in India during this age is the MOST accurate?

- (A) they erased Indian culture and replaced it entirely with their own
- (B) they stayed wholly apart and mixed with nothing Indian at all
- (C) they were largely absorbed into Indian culture, which remained the dominant influence
- (D) they unified the whole subcontinent under one lasting foreign empire

53. A debate motion reads: 'Political division and cultural creativity cannot flourish at the same time.' Using this chapter, the BEST single rebuttal is that:

- (A) a single empire kept the subcontinent unified and peaceful throughout the age
- (B) the very centuries of many rival kingdoms also produced new art schools, busy long-distance trade and enduring Sanskrit literature
- (C) creativity only resumed once one large empire had been restored
- (D) the foreign rulers suppressed all Indian culture while the kingdoms were divided

54. A student lists three claims about the Satavahanas: (i) they were a Deccan power, (ii) their ship-coins evidence sea trade, (iii) a Satavahana queen performed the ashvamedha. How many of these does the chapter support?

- (A) only the first and second are supported
- (B) only the first and third are supported
- (C) only the second and third are supported
- (D) all three are supported

55. Why does the chapter present the Gandhara Buddha in Greek robes as the clearest single emblem of the whole age's character?

- (A) because it proves the age rejected all foreign influence in its art
- (B) because it shows the Buddha was actually a Greek god
- (C) because it demonstrates that Indian art stopped during the foreign presence
- (D) because it shows a foreign form and an Indian subject merged into one work, capturing the age's cultural confluence in a single object

56. A pupil claims that 'cultural confluence' means one culture completely replaced another. The chapter's own definition corrects this to mean:

- (A) the total replacement of one culture by another
- (B) the strict keeping of every culture entirely separate
- (C) the blending of different traditions into new shared styles while a dominant Indian character remains
- (D) the spread of a single unchanging culture with no mixing at all

57. Suppose only ONE source survived for an unknown northwestern king of this age: a silver coin bearing a Greek-style portrait and an Indian deity. Which of these could the historian legitimately establish from it alone?

- (A) the exact extent and boundaries of his entire kingdom
- (B) the year-by-year narrative of his military campaigns
- (C) the size of his standing army and his tax revenues
- (D) the ruler's appearance in Greek style and his openness to an Indian god, pointing to cultural blending

58. A timeline expert is asked which event made the others possible. The chapter's logic points to:

- (A) the internal breakup of the Maurya empire, which weakened the northwest and opened the way for foreign rulers to enter
- (B) the arrival of the Indo-Greeks, which then broke up the Maurya empire
- (C) the rise of the Satavahanas, which then weakened the Maurya frontier
- (D) Kanishka's Kushana rule, which then triggered the Maurya collapse

59. Which pairing of a power with the BEST surviving evidence for it is correct?

- (A) the Indo-Greek kings — the Sangam Tamil poems
- (B) Kharavela of Kalinga — the Hathigumpha inscription
- (C) the Tamil sea trade — the Bharhut Stupa railings
- (D) the Satavahana queens — Kanishka's many-gods coins

60. A final synthesis question: which single sentence most completely and accurately captures the chapter's portrait of the Age of Reorganisation?

- (A) a single empire peacefully unified the subcontinent while foreign rulers erased Indian culture
- (B) many competing kingdoms across regions coexisted with rich cultural blending, long-distance sea and land trade, and the absorption of foreign rulers into a dominant Indian culture
- (C) a cultural dark age with no art, trade or literature followed the Mauryan collapse
- (D) foreign invaders destroyed the Mauryas from outside and then ruled the whole subcontinent as one empire

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 6: The Age of Reorganisation — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	C	31	C	41	A	51	C
2	D	12	B	22	C	32	D	42	C	52	C
3	B	13	D	23	D	33	B	43	B	53	B
4	A	14	D	24	C	34	B	44	B	54	D
5	B	15	C	25	B	35	A	45	A	55	D
6	A	16	D	26	A	36	C	46	D	56	C
7	A	17	A	27	C	37	C	47	D	57	D
8	A	18	D	28	C	38	C	48	A	58	A
9	D	19	C	29	D	39	A	49	A	59	B
10	B	20	D	30	A	40	B	50	A	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) The timeline places the internal weakening and the assassination before the Indo-Greek entry, and a cause must come before its effect, so a later arrival cannot have produced the earlier collapse. The commander (Pushyamitra Shunga) was an insider of the Mauryan army, not an Indo-Greek, so that is not the flaw. The Indo-Greeks and Mauryas were different peoples, so equating them is simply wrong. The northwest had in fact belonged to the Mauryas, so denying it misstates the chapter. The only flaw in the reasoning itself is confusing later-in-sequence with cause.

2. (D) 'Reorganisation' is justified because political reshaping went hand in hand with thriving art, trade and literature, not cultural loss. A single reunifying emperor never appeared, so that claim is false and would not support either label. Foreign rulers held only parts of the north, not every kingdom. Far from leaving no evidence, the age is known precisely through its coins, inscriptions and monuments, so that statement reverses the truth and would wrongly support 'decline'.

3. (B) The defining mark against a 'dark age' is the simultaneous flourishing of art, trade and literature. No single empire kept the subcontinent peaceful, so that is false. Writing did not disappear; the age is reconstructed from its written inscriptions and coin legends. Rome traded with India but did not rule any of its kingdoms, so the last option is also false.

4. (A) The key contrast is internal-coup versus later outside entry: Pushyamitra was the Mauryan commander-in-chief who killed the last emperor, while the Indo-Greeks were foreigners who entered the weakened northwest afterwards. They were not simultaneous foreign invaders, nor were their origins reversed (Pushyamitra was Indian, the Indo-Greeks foreign). Neither came to power by election, so that option is false.

5. (B) The ashvamedha stakes a sovereignty claim and the marriage forges a diplomatic alliance; both are politics carried out through other forms. Neither is merely a private or religious act, which is exactly the trap the chapter warns against. Neither is a tribute-collection mechanism, and neither selects a successor, so those options misread the purpose of both acts.

6. (A) One record of a queen performing the rite shows women could hold real authority, that the Vedic sacrifice survived, and that the rite carried a sovereignty claim. It does NOT show women ruled more commonly than men; a single example cannot establish that women outnumbered male rulers. That over-generalisation is the inference the record cannot support, so it is the correct 'except' choice.

7. (A) A mother-derived royal name plus a recorded land-grant by that mother jointly point to the high standing of royal women. The naming was after the mother, not a god, so the first distractor is false. Nothing here suggests renunciation of the throne. 'Gautami' is the mother's name, not a city, so that misreads the same evidence. The two facts converge on women's standing.

8. (A) All three items in the correct set concern royal women exercising naming-prestige, property and ritual sovereignty, which directly refutes the men-only claim. Ship-coins, Roman gold and a milestone speak to trade, not women's power. The Bharhut Stupa, Heliodorus pillar and Anicut concern religion, diplomacy and irrigation. Sangam poems, the Shaka era and Kanishka's coins concern poetry, timekeeping and religion. Only the first set bears on the gender claim.

9. (D) The resolving principle is patronage across traditions: a Vedic-reviving dynasty could still adorn a Buddhist monument. There is no evidence of a secret conversion, and inventing one is unnecessary. The Bharhut Stupa is genuinely Buddhist, not a relabelled Vedic temple. Buddhism plainly had not died out, since its monument was being actively embellished. Only the cross-tradition patronage principle dissolves the puzzle.

10. (B) A samvat is indeed a counted era from a fixed event, as the Shaka samvat shows. A stupa is a Buddhist dome, not a dam (that is an anicut). An anicut is a river-dam, not a

Buddhist monument (that swap is the trap). The ashvamedha is a horse-sacrifice, not a poetry anthology (those are the Sangam works). Only the samvat pairing holds.

11. (B) The Shungas held north-central India, the Satavahanas the Deccan, Kharavela ruled Kalinga on the eastern coast, and the Pandyas were one of the Tamil far-southern crowned kingdoms; only the first set matches every region. Each other option scrambles at least two of these well-attested placements, for example putting the Shungas in the Deccan or the Pandyas in the northwest, which the chapter never supports.

12. (B) The ship-coin and Roman gold mark sea trade while the Silk-Route milestone marks land trade, so together they show commerce by both sea and land. They are evidence of exchange, not of military conquest by Rome or China. They contradict the idea of village-only trade. And because they include both a sea route and a land route, they disprove the 'single route' claim.

13. (D) Coins demonstrate trade, but rule would need administrative traces such as governors or garrisons, which are absent, so trade is the sound inference. The coins were genuine Roman pieces paid for goods, not Indian forgeries. Distance plainly did not block contact, since the coins did arrive. And there is no record of Indian kings being crowned at Rome, so that is invented.

14. (D) An inscription fixes a concrete deed in stable wording, while a flattering poem may inflate its subject, so the inscription is the firmer evidence. Poems were not inherently more accurate; the point is the opposite. Queens did not personally carve their grants, so that reason is false even though it picks the right source. And sources clearly do tell us about women, since the chapter reconstructs their standing from exactly such records.

15. (C) Coins typically carry names, titles and portraits, while inscriptions narrate deeds and gifts in words, so each has a distinct strength. The first distractor reverses these roles. Both sources can in fact give a ruler's name, so calling them unreliable on that point is wrong. Coins are not forgeries; both are authentic ancient evidence.

16. (D) Kanishka's many-gods coins reveal religious leanings and Indo-Greek coins reveal names and portraits, so coins can recover identity, titles and beliefs when texts are scarce. They are not limited to measuring metal wealth. They reveal which gods were honoured, not refused. And their value comes from what they record, not from being unused, since they did circulate in trade.

17. (A) The Satavahanas of the Deccan traded by sea through western ports, while the Kushanas controlled the overland Silk Route, so the two routes must be kept apart. Saying both used the Silk Route ignores Satavahana sea trade. Reversing the pair gives the Kushanas the sea and the Satavahanas the land, which is backwards. Saying both used sea ports ignores the Kushana Silk-Route dominance.

18. (D) The Satavahanas and Tamil kingdoms both traded with Rome by sea, while the Kushanas profited from the overland Silk Route, so the Kushanas are wrongly grouped with the maritime traders. They did not all use the Silk Route. The Satavahanas reached Rome by sea, not land. And the Tamil kingdoms used the sea, not the Silk Route, so the last option also misassigns the routes.

19. (C) Familiarity with a region's products follows naturally from trading for them, so the notes evidence commerce, not rule. Roman writers wrote about many lands they never conquered, so the first distractor is false. The notes show goods moving toward Rome, not Tamil kings ruling Italy. And buyers learn about goods through trade, not only through colonisation, so the last claim is wrong.

20. (D) Repeated praise for giving shows that generosity was valued in a ruler, which is the reliable reading. The poems praise gift-giving, so a ban on gifts is the opposite of what they show. They name and praise chiefs, so chiefs clearly existed and wealth was not perfectly equal. And the poems are about love and heroism, not Vedic sacrifice, so the last option misdescribes their content.

21. (C) An anicut is a river-dam for irrigation, exactly what the Grand Anicut did for the Kaveri delta. A dome-shaped monument is a stupa, not an anicut. A counted era is a samvat. A marriage treaty is a matrimonial alliance. Only the irrigation-dam definition fits the term.

22. (C) The anicut irrigated the delta into fertile rice land, the economic foundation of Chola power, which a fort could not provide. It was a dam, not a fortress, so it had no primary military role. It raised and diverted water rather than blocking ships. And it was an irrigation work, not a boundary marker, so the last option misreads its purpose.

23. (D) The Maurya breakup came first; only after it weakened the frontier did the Indo-Greeks enter, the Satavahanas then rose in the Deccan, and Kanishka's Kushanas came later still. Placing Kanishka or the Satavahanas before the Maurya breakup reverses the sequence the chapter sets out. Placing the Indo-Greek entry before the breakup contradicts the cause-and-effect order the chapter stresses.

24. (C) The Shungas were an Indian dynasty of the heartland and the Indo-Greeks were foreigners in the northwest, so the labels are correct. The Indo-Greeks were foreign, not indigenous, so the first distractor mislabels them. The Satavahanas were an indigenous Deccan power, not foreign. The Cholas were an indigenous Tamil kingdom, not foreign, so the last option is wrong too.

25. (B) The Bharhut railing is heartland Buddhist art adorned under the Shungas, while the Indo-Greek coin is the main portrait record of a northwestern foreign king, so the contrast holds. The railing is not Mathura red sandstone, and a coin is not sculpture, so the

first distractor is wrong. The railing was made under an Indian dynasty, not a foreign one. And neither object is a sea-trade token for pepper, so the last option is false.

26. (A) A Greek portrait beside an Indian god in Indian script literally combines two cultures on one coin, supporting cultural blending. It cannot show rejection of Indian languages and gods, since an Indian god is named on it. One coin says nothing about ruling the whole subcontinent. And striking coins shows engagement with money and trade, not indifference to it.

27. (C) A Greek ambassador honouring an Indian deity directly shows cultural blending and the adoption of Indian belief. It cannot show Greek gods being forced on Indians, since the object honours an Indian god. It is the opposite of refusing contact with Indian religion. And it records reverence, not the destruction of shrines, so the last option contradicts the object itself.

28. (C) Toga-folds and wavy hair mark the Greco-Buddhist Gandhara school, which visibly merges a foreign form with an Indian Buddhist subject, so it best shows confluence; the spotted red-sandstone figure is the indigenous Mathura style. Swapping the two schools, as the other options do, reverses the trap the chapter warns against, and the indigenous Mathura piece is essentially one local tradition, so it is not the better example of blending.

29. (D) Gandhara visibly joins a Greek form to an Indian Buddhist subject, which is exactly what confluence means, whereas Mathura is largely a single indigenous tradition. Gandhara was strongly shaped by Greek form, so saying it had no foreign influence is wrong. Mathura was the indigenous school and Gandhara the blended one, so reversing them is false. And Gandhara is sculpture, not Tamil poetry.

30. (A) The textbook has swapped the two: Gandhara is the Greek-Buddhist blend and Mathura is the indigenous red-sandstone school, so restoring that fixes both halves. Gandhara was sculpture, not Tamil poetry. Neither school was purely Greek; Mathura was indigenous and Gandhara only partly Greek. And both were sculpture schools, not poetry, so the last option is false.

31. (C) Both statements are true and the reason explains the assertion: because Indian culture stayed dominant and absorbed the newcomers' contributions, the foreigners are counted as contributors rather than destroyers. The assertion is not false, and the reason is not false; the chapter affirms both. So only the option affirming both and linking them is correct.

32. (D) Indian themes staying central while foreign forms were taken in shows absorption and reshaping, not erasure. It is not violent expulsion, since foreign elements were retained, just reframed. It is the opposite of being wholly Hellenised, since the Indian core remained dominant. And art clearly continued, so a halt in activity is false.

33. (B) The Kushanas grew rich from the overland Silk Route, not from western Deccan sea ports, so that statement is the misdescription; the Deccan sea trade belonged to the Satavahanas. The Shungas did revive Vedic ritual and adorn Bharhut, the Satavahanas did trade by sea as ship-coins show, and the Cholas did build the Grand Anicut, so those three are all accurate.

34. (B) The counter-example is the coexistence of many rival kingdoms with thriving art, trade and Sanskrit literature, which directly refutes 'barren'. There was no single unifying emperor, so that option is false. Art and trade did not stop; they flourished. And foreign rulers absorbed rather than banned Indian culture, so the last option contradicts the chapter.

35. (A) Kharavela combined kingship over Kalinga with personal devotion to Jainism, which is why he is called a monk-king. He did not abdicate to wander, since he kept ruling. He was a Kalinga ruler, not a Kushana governor of Gandhara. And he followed an existing faith rather than founding a new religion.

36. (C) Knowing Kharavela mainly through one carved inscription shows that the age is recovered largely from inscriptions, not running chronicles. Continuous court chronicles did not survive for these kingdoms, which is the very gap inscriptions fill. Roman ledgers did not list Indian kings systematically. And Sangam poems are southern Tamil works, not records of an eastern king like Kharavela.

37. (C) The three crowned Tamil kingdoms are the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas, all of the far south. Each distractor swaps in a non-Tamil power: the Satavahanas of the Deccan, the Shungas of the heartland, or the Kushanas of the northwest. Only the all-Tamil list is correct.

38. (C) Both halves of the pupil's claim are wrong: the Shakas are the Indo-Scythians, not the Indo-Greeks, and they ARE tied to the lasting Shaka samvat. The first distractor still misidentifies them as Indo-Greeks. The second wrongly says no lasting calendar survives. The third both misidentifies them as Kushanas and invents a Roman calendar link. Only the option correcting both errors is right.

39. (A) A calendar still in national use is a living legacy, so the age left lasting marks, not just ruins. It plainly did produce something that outlived it, contradicting the first distractor. The Shaka era is Indian, not a Roman creation. And a calendar woven into Indian life shows deep contact with Indian traditions, not its absence.

40. (B) Kanishka was the famous Kushana ruler tied to the Silk Route, so that triple match is correct. Pushyamitra was a Shunga, not a Kushana. Kharavela ruled Kalinga, not the Satavahana realm, and the Anicut was a Chola work. Gautamiputra was a Satavahana, not an Indo-Greek, and the Heliodorus pillar was set up by a Greek ambassador, so each other option mismatches power or deed.

41. (A) The Kushanas controlled the overland Silk Route, a land artery the sea-trading Satavahanas could not hold. The western Deccan sea routes were exactly the Satavahanas' own sphere, so they are not the Kushana source. The Kaveri canals were a Chola irrigation work, not a trade route. And the Sangam 'circuit' is not a trade route at all, so only the Silk Route fits.

42. (C) The Silk Route was a network of overland routes from China through Central Asia to the Mediterranean. It was not a sea lane, which is how the Satavahanas and Tamils reached Rome. It was not a Chola delta road, and it was not a poets' circuit, so only the overland-network description is accurate.

43. (B) The chapter links the great Sanskrit epics, the Mahabharata and Ramayana, to this age, and their flourishing argues against any 'dark age' label. The Sangam works are Tamil, not Sanskrit, and do not prove the north produced nothing. The Hathigumpha inscription is a royal record, not the age's only literature. And the Arthashastra belongs to the earlier Mauryan court, not to this period.

44. (B) The right reason is that the evidence is largely physical, since continuous written chronicles did not survive, even though people could read and write, as the inscriptions themselves prove. The first distractor keeps the pupil's false claim that no one could read or write. The age did leave buildings, such as stupas. And its history was not all Roman translation, so those options are wrong.

45. (A) Coins, cave inscriptions and sculptures are all surviving physical objects of the age. Election ballots, newspapers, emails, photographs, passports, constitutions, voter rolls and tax records are all modern documents that did not exist then, so any list containing them is wrong. Only the all-ancient, all-physical list qualifies.

46. (D) The coin evidences Greek-Indian cultural blending while the inscription evidences a queen's high standing, so they illuminate different themes. Neither shows Roman rule, which would need administrative traces. Neither concerns the Silk Route, since one is a northwest coin and the other a Deccan land-grant. And both are in fact reliable physical sources, so dismissing them is wrong.

47. (D) Gandhara's blending, Kanishka honouring Indian and other gods, and a Greek ambassador revering an Indian deity all show foreigners absorbing and enriching Indian culture, the heart of the 'contributors' case. Roman gold, ship-coins and the Anicut concern trade and irrigation among indigenous powers. The Bharhut Stupa, Sangam poetry and Tamil kingdoms are indigenous, not foreign. Kharavela and the Kaveri likewise involve no foreign rulers, so only the first set bears on the claim.

48. (A) The Shungas revived Vedic ritual while still adorning the Buddhist Bharhut Stupa, the supported reading. They were an indigenous heartland dynasty, not foreigners from Alexander's governors (that describes the Indo-Greeks). The Silk Route was the Kushanas'

source of wealth. And the Grand Anicut was a Chola work, so each distractor borrows another power's trait.

49. (A) A ship-coin from a Deccan port best supports flourishing maritime trade, and it certainly does not prove the dynasty lost its land, since the Satavahanas held the Deccan. The ship marks trade, not sea-worship. There is no evidence of a war-fleet built against the Kushanas. And the dynasty did not survive 'only at sea', so the land-loss claim is unsupported.

50. (A) A royal marriage could convert a rivalry into an alliance and extend a kingdom's influence, so it was diplomacy, not merely a wedding. Weddings did not all include a horse-sacrifice, which is a separate sovereignty ritual. Marriage was not a tribute mechanism. And calling it a purely private event is exactly the misreading the chapter rejects.

51. (C) The flaw is over-generalising the sea-trade pattern to the Kushanas, whose wealth actually flowed from the overland Silk Route, not the sea. The argument does not deny Satavahana sea trade; it accepts it. It does not deny that the Cheras and Pandyas were Tamil kingdoms. And it makes no claim about Rome lying on the Silk Route, so only the over-generalisation is the real fault.

52. (C) The foreign rulers were largely absorbed into a still-dominant Indian culture, as their Indian-themed coins and art show. They did not erase Indian culture, nor did they stay wholly apart, since blending is everywhere visible. And no single foreign empire unified the subcontinent, so the last option is false.

53. (B) The rebuttal points to division and creativity coexisting: rival kingdoms alongside new art, trade and Sanskrit works. There was no single unifying empire, so that claim is false. Creativity did not pause and resume; it ran throughout. And foreign rulers absorbed rather than suppressed Indian culture, so the last option contradicts the chapter.

54. (D) All three are supported: the Satavahanas held the Deccan, their ship-coins evidence sea trade, and a widowed Satavahana queen is recorded performing the ashvamedha. Since every claim is accurate, any option excluding one of them is wrong, leaving 'all three' as the only correct answer.

55. (D) A Greek-robed Buddha unites a foreign style with an Indian subject in one image, distilling the age's confluence, which is why it is so emblematic. It does not show rejection of foreign influence; it embraces it. It does not turn the Buddha into a Greek god; it gives an Indian subject a Greek form. And it is itself active art, disproving any claim that Indian art stopped.

56. (C) Confluence is blending into new shared styles with a dominant Indian core preserved, not replacement. The pupil's 'complete replacement' is exactly the error being

corrected. Keeping cultures strictly separate is the opposite of blending. And spreading one unchanging culture with no mixing again misses the blending that confluence requires.

57. (D) A single coin can establish the ruler's Greek-style portrait and his honouring of an Indian god, hence cultural blending. It cannot map the kingdom's exact boundaries, narrate campaigns year by year, or reveal army size and tax revenues, all of which would require far more evidence than one coin supplies.

58. (A) The Maurya breakup came first and weakened the frontier, enabling later foreign entry, so it is the enabling event. The Indo-Greek arrival followed the breakup and could not have caused it. The Satavahanas rose after the breakup, not before. And Kanishka's Kushana rule came later still, so none of these could have triggered the earlier Maurya collapse.

59. (B) Kharavela of Kalinga is known chiefly from the Hathigumpha inscription, so that match is correct. The Indo-Greek kings are known mainly from their coins, not Sangam poems, which are southern Tamil works. Tamil sea trade is evidenced by Roman gold hoards, not Bharhut railings, which are Shunga-era Buddhist art. And Satavahana queens are known from their own land-grant inscriptions, not Kanishka's coins, so each distractor misassigns the evidence.

60. (B) The fullest accurate picture combines political fragmentation, cultural confluence, sea and land trade, and the absorption of foreigners into a dominant Indian culture. There was no single peaceful empire, and foreign rulers did not erase Indian culture, so the first option is doubly wrong. The age was creatively rich, not a dark age. And the Mauryas fell from within, not from an outside invasion that then unified the subcontinent, so the last option misstates both cause and outcome.